

Felipe Chicaiza

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EDUCATION

Florida International University - Miami, FL

Expected December 2025

Bachelors of Arts in Computer Science & Minor in Mathematics - GPA: 3.7

Courses: Data Structures and Algorithms, C & C++ Programming, Operating Systems, Systems Design

SKILLS

Languages: Python, Java, C++, Go, C, TypeScript, JavaScript, SQL, HTML, CSS

Frameworks: Node.js, React, Next.js, Spring Boot, MySQL, Git, Agile, Postman, JUCE, Ocelot, Cyberduck

Certifications: CodePath TIP 102 (Technical Interview Prep), CodePath Web 102 (Web Development)

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

IT & Network System Intern | Florida Department of Transportation | Miami, FL

May 2025 - Current

- Managed over **250 workstations** district-wide, handling configuration, imaging, and technical support; utilized Active Directory for account management and ServiceNow for ticketing and resolution.
- Developed and maintained district wide **web applications**, including **GIS mapping tools**, **Microsoft Power Apps** project management lists, and the Financial Services web platform, supporting operational needs across planning, HR, and finance departments.
- Engineered a document sorting and indexing system that replaced manual file-by-file checks with instant case-number lookups, reducing retrieval time from **15–20 minutes** to under **1 minute**.

Codepath Fellow | Remote

December 2024 - Current

- Mentored **150+** students through 1:1 and group sessions, delivering resume reviews and interview prep that improved candidate competitiveness in **Python**.
- Guided a cohort of students through **Object Oriented Programming** and **data structures** in **Python**, breaking down complex concepts into clear explanations that improved student confidence and technical readiness.
- Drove measurable engagement: **33% of mentees** (50+) returned for follow-up sessions and participated in additional workshops.

Project Manager & Lead Engineer | INIT Build – Florida International University

September - Nov 2024

- Architected and developed a **C++ audio plugin** using the JUCE framework, applying **object-oriented design** and real-time programming principles to ensure stable low-latency performance.
- Optimized CPU usage and memory allocation by leveraging **RAII patterns**, **efficient buffer management**, and **multithreading techniques**, ensuring glitch-free playback under stress tests.
- Deployed the plugin in a **live demonstration with 180+ students**, where participants successfully tested features in real time, validating performance and usability under live audio conditions.

PROJECTS

Decentralized File Storage System | Go, TCP, P2P Networking, Encryption

August 2025 - Current

- Designed and implemented a peer-to-peer distributed file storage system in **Go**, supporting file upload, retrieval, and removal across multiple networked nodes.
- Built custom TCP transport with handshake protocol, error handling, and a custom decoder to ensure reliable data exchange between peers.
- Implemented **file encryption/decryption**, **message broadcasting**, and **distributed replication** to improve data security and availability.

Github | [Link](#)

Global News Network | React, Three.js, Tailwind, Express.js, MongoDB

September 2025

Hackathon Project – ShellHacks 2025

- Designed and implemented a **3D interactive news platform** where users explore stories on a globe, view local feeds with credibility scores, and read AI-generated summaries.
- Built the frontend with **React**, **TailwindCSS**, and **Three.js**, solving rendering performance issues to enable smooth zoom and interaction on the globe.
- Coordinated frontend, backend, and AI pipelines as **project lead**, ensuring delivery of a polished MVP in under **30 hours**.

Devpost | [Link](#)

LEADERSHIP & AFFILIATIONS

Campus Ambassador | CodePath x FIU E³ Program

September - November 2024

- Championed CodePath adoption at FIU, leading to **official credit recognition (3 credits)** for select courses and expanding free access to qualifying students.

INIT FIU | Team Lead, Project Manager & Member | FIU

September 2023 - Current